

Photo: Southern Swedish Forest Research Centre. SLU. Sweden.

# *Ishfaq Ahmad Khan*

## PERSONAL INFORMATION


**Gender:** Male
**Nationality:** Pakistani
**Location:** Joensuu, Finland

**E-mails:** khanish@uef.com /ishfaqahmad860@gmail.com

**Personal Website:** https://ishfaqforester.weebly.com/

**Google Scholar:** https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=k2B3IGgAAAAJ&hl=en


## SKILLS

**Technical:**
R, Python (working knowledge), QGIS, GPS, and Other Forest tools, including (ultrasonic) hypsometer, Clinometer, Haga altimeter, Increment Borer, etc.

**ORGANIZATIONAL:**
Strong ability to work collaboratively in teams, with proven experience in effective communication, coordination, and fostering productive work environment.

**LINGUISTICS:**

**Mother tongue:** Pushto/Pashto

English: Fluent
Urdu: Fluent
Finnish: Beginner

## SUMMARY:


Forestry graduate and early-career researcher in forestry with a strong academic background in **forestry**, statistical modeling, **R programming**, and **field-based** forest research. Since 2017, I have held different roles (forest field assistant, forest inventory assistant, research trainee, and research assistant) at Pakistan Forest Institute, Peshawar, Rehman Habib Consultant (Pvt) Limited, and the University of Eastern Finland. My **current research** focuses on (height-diameter) **model transferability** using parametric and data-driven approaches. Broadly, **my research interests** revolve around **regeneration**, **forest structure**, height-diameter modeling, **stand dynamics,** and **forest dynamics** within the field of forest sciences.


## EDUCATION:

Degree: **Master of Science (Forestry)**
Year: June 2026
University: School of Forest Sciences, **University of Eastern Finland**, Finland.
Research Area: Tree height-diameter model transferability

Degree: **Master of Science (MSc) in Forest Management and Ecosystem Sciences**
Year: 2022 (Research-based degree)
University: Department of Forest Science & Biodiversity, **University Putra Malaysia** (UPM), Serdang, Malaysia
Main subjects: Advanced Statistical Methods, Research Methodology, and Special Topic (published a review paper under this course).
Research Area: Forest restoration and regeneration ecology

Degree: **Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Forestry**
Year: 2014
University: Pakistan Forest Institute, Peshawar, University of Peshawar, Pakistan.
Main subjects: Forest Ecology, Soil Science, Forest Mensuration, Silviculture, Forest Statistics and Research Methods, Forest Management, and GIS and Remote Sensing
Research Area (Term Paper): Forest Fire

## OTHER TRAININGS:

**Course:** Geomatics in Forestry: Data Collection and Management.
**University:** University of British Columbia, Canada

**Course:** GIS training program using QGIS
**University:** Central University of Karnataka, India.

## WORK EXPERIENCE: APPROX. 04 YEARS

October 2025 – December 2025 (03 months)
**Research trainee** at the School of Forest Sciences, University of Eastern Finland.
**Task:** Tree **height-diameter model** transferability using **parametric** and **data-driven approaches**.

April 2025 – July 2025
**Research Assistant (Volunteer)** at the acidic peatland restoration project at the University of Eastern Finland.
**Tasks**: Preparation of peat soil and biochar treatment, greenhouse experiment setup, plant maintenance, soil PH monitoring, leachate collection, and plant growth measurements. Support in data recording, laboratory analysis, and general maintenance of the experimental setup.

July 2023 – January 2024 (06 months)
**Forest field assistant** at Rehman Habib Consultant (Pvt) limited, Pakistan.
Project: Feasibility Study PC (II) for Command Area Development of Small Dams Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
**Task:** Primary data collection related to the **forest** on the designated forms of 29 small dams and one irrigation scheme in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
Submission of **analyzed final** data and **report writing**.

August 2018- Jul 2019 (01 year)
**Research Assistant** at Pakistan Forest Institute, University of Peshawar, Pakistan.
Project: Sustainable Forest Management
**Task: Data collection** on growing stock and **carbon stocks** in agroforestry systems

## REFERENCES

Available on request.

Socio-economic surveys and the collection of baseline data in the field
Area measurement through **GPS**
Data entry and **analysis** using MS Excel

Jul 2017- June 2018 (01 year)
**Forest Inventory Assistant** at Pakistan Forest Institute, Peshawar.
Project: Sustainable Forest Management
**Task:** Laying out sample plots on GIS maps and GT sheets.
Data collection on AGB, deadwood, leaf litter, and soil carbon.
Data entry and **analysis** using MS Excel.

November 2013- October 2014 (01 year)
**Intern** at the Pakistan Forest Institute, Peshawar.
Project: Carbon Stock Assessment of Forests of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
**Tasks**: Laying out sample plots on GIS maps and GT sheets.
Navigation to sample points through GPS.
Establishment of sample plots in the forest.
**Data collection** on above-ground biomass and **soil carbon**.
**Data entry** and **analysis** using MS Excel.

## PUBLICATIONS/CONFERENCES:

08 peer-reviewed scientific articles in national and international journals (attached as a separate list).

## AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS:

- Recipient of the **Finland Scholarship** for my master's degree in forestry at the **University of Eastern Finland**.

## GRANTS/FUNDING FOR RESEARCH PROJECTS AND TRAVELING

2025 **Visiting Researcher grant (Intern) (03 months)** from **Mitacs Globalink Research Award (GRA)** for "evaluating the impact of water availability on juvenile tree survival and establishment" at the University of Regina, Canada (could not conduct the project due to visa issues).